

Word family: **impress / impressed / impressing / impressive / impressively / impression**

Base word: impress

Past tense: impressed

Past participle: impressed

ing form: impressing

Related forms: impressive, impressively, impression

Part of speech: verb (動詞) / adjective-related forms (相關形容詞) / noun-related form (相關名詞)

Your sentence:

> “Another reason I find him so interesting is that he never talks just to **impress** people.”

Meaning in this passage

Here, **impress** means to **make other people admire you or think highly of you because of what you say, do, know, own, or achieve**.

The speaker is saying that Mr. Wong does not talk simply because he wants other people to think he is clever, knowledgeable, or remarkable.

**繁體中文： ** **透過自己的說話、行為、能力、知識或成就，使別人產生欣賞、佩服或高度評價

**

**中文翻譯： **

> “He never talks just to **impress** people.”

「他從來不是純粹為了**讓別人佩服 / 令別人對他留下深刻好印象**才說話。」

Here:

impress people = 令別人對自己的能力、特質或表現產生欣賞或佩服

1. **impress + person (人物) — 令.....留下深刻好印象；使佩服**

This is the meaning used in your passage.

Meaning: To cause someone to admire, respect, or think highly of a person, performance, ability, achievement, etc.

Practice 1 — Original

> “He never talks just to ****impress**** people.”

「他從來不是純粹為了****讓別人佩服****才說話。」

Practice 2

> “Her calm response ****impressed**** everyone in the room.”

「她冷靜的回應令房間裡所有人都****留下深刻好印象 / 十分佩服****。」

Practice 3

> “He tried to ****impress**** the interviewer with his knowledge.”

「他試圖用自己的知識來****令面試官留下好印象 / 對他刮目相看****。」

****impress someone = 令某人因你的能力、表現、特質或成就而產生欣賞、佩服或高度評價****

Common patterns:

- * impress someone
- * impress the audience
- * impress the interviewer
- * impress people with something
- * be impressed by something
- * be impressed with something

These are one underlying sense.

2. ****impress something on/upon + person (觀念 / 重要性) — 使深刻記住；強調使人明白****

This is a genuinely different meaning.

****Meaning:**** To make someone understand, remember, or take something seriously by emphasizing it strongly.

Practice 4

> “The teacher ****impressed on**** the students the importance of checking their work.”

「老師向學生****再三強調****檢查功課的重要性，令他們深刻記住。」

Practice 5

> “She ****impressed upon**** him the need to remain careful.”

「她向他****鄭重強調****保持小心的必要性。」

****impress something on/upon someone = 強烈地向某人指出某件事，使對方深刻理解、記住或重視****

This does ****not**** mean making the person admire you.

Compare:

> “She impressed him.”

= 她令他很佩服。

> “She impressed the importance of safety upon him.”

= 她令他深刻明白安全的重要性。

These require two different mental concepts.

3. ****impress + mark/design/shape on/into a surface (印痕 / 圖案) — 壓印；印上****

This is the older physical core behind the figurative senses, but it remains valid modern English.

****Meaning:**** To press a mark, shape, design, or pattern into or onto a surface so that it leaves an impression.

Practice 6

> “The seal was ****impressed into**** the soft wax.”

「印章被****壓印在****柔軟的蠟上。」

Practice 7

> “A decorative pattern was ****impressed on**** the surface of the clay.”

「黏土表面被****壓印上****裝飾圖案。」

****impress a mark/design on/into something = 透過壓力在表面留下清楚的形狀、圖案或印痕****

This is clearly different from psychological admiration.

Related form: ****impressed****

****Impressed**** describes the person experiencing admiration or a strong favourable reaction.

Practice 8

> “I was very ****impressed**** by her presentation.”

「她的簡報令我****印象非常深刻 / 十分佩服****。」

Practice 9

> “They were ****impressed with**** the quality of the work.”

「他們對工作的質素****十分欣賞 / 留下深刻好印象****。」

****be impressed = 因某人的能力、表現或某事物的品質而感到欣賞、佩服或驚喜****

Related form: ****impressive****

****Impressive**** describes the person or thing that causes admiration.

Practice 10

> “She gave an ****impressive**** performance.”

「她帶來了一場****令人印象深刻 / 令人佩服的****表演。」

Practice 11

> “The building is architecturally ****impressive****.”

「這座建築在建築設計上非常****令人讚嘆****。」

****impressive = 因品質、規模、能力或表現出色而令人產生欣賞或佩服的****

Important distinction: ****impressed vs impressive****

This is the most important family contrast.

impressed

describes the **person who feels admiration**.

> “I am **impressed**.”

「我感到佩服 / 印象深刻。」

impressive

describes the **person or thing causing that feeling**.

> “The performance is **impressive**.”

「這場表演令人佩服 / 印象深刻。」

So:

impressed = 感受到好印象的人

impressive = 令人產生好印象的人 / 事物

This is similar to learner contrasts such as *interested / interesting*.

Related form: **impressively**

Practice 12

> “She spoke **impressively** without using any notes.”

「她完全不用筆記，仍然講得**非常出色、令人印象深刻**。」

Practice 13

> “The company grew **impressively** quickly.”

「這家公司以**令人驚訝而印象深刻的速度**快速增長。」

impressively = 以令人欣賞、佩服或感到出色的方式

Related form: **impression**

****Impression**** is an important family member, but it has substantial polysemy of its own.

For this ****impress**** entry, the most directly relevant sense is:

****impression = opinion or feeling formed about someone/something (印象) ****

Practice 14

> “She made a very good first ****impression****.”

「她給人留下了非常好的第一****印象****。」

Practice 15

> “My first ****impression**** of him was completely wrong.”

「我對他的第一****印象****完全錯了。」

****impression = 接觸某人或某事物後，在腦中形成的整體看法或感受****

However, ****impression**** also has other important meanings, such as:

- * a physical mark left by pressure;
- * an imitation of someone's voice or behaviour;
- * a general idea that may not be certain.

Because ****impression**** has its own substantial polysemy, I would treat it as a separate future target rather than fully expand it here.

Important distinction: ****impress vs surprise****

****impress****

usually involves admiration or a strong favourable evaluation.

> “Her knowledge impressed me.”

= 她的知識令我佩服。

****surprise****

means something was unexpected.

> “Her answer surprised me.”

= 她的答案令我感到意外。

Something can surprise you ****without impressing you****, and impress you without being surprising.

Important distinction: ****impress vs inspire****

****impress****

= cause admiration

****inspire****

= encourage someone to feel motivated, creative, hopeful, or willing to act

> “His skill impressed me.”

= 他的能力令我佩服。

> “His story inspired me to try again.”

= 他的故事鼓勵我再次嘗試。

The emotional result is different.

Important distinction: ****impress vs show off****

This is especially relevant to your passage.

****impress someone****

can be neutral or positive:

> “Her work impressed the judges.”

****show off****

means deliberately displaying abilities, possessions, etc. because you want attention or admiration, and often carries a negative tone.

Your sentence:

> “He never talks just to impress people.”

suggests that Mr. Wong is ****not deliberately performing for admiration****.

But ****impress**** itself is not automatically negative.

Important distinction: ****impress someone vs impress something on someone****

This grammatical contrast changes the meaning substantially.

****impress someone****

> “The speaker impressed me.”

= 講者令我佩服。

****impress something on someone****

> “The speaker impressed the importance of honesty on us.”

= 講者令我們深刻明白誠實的重要性。

So:

****person immediately after impress → cause admiration****

****idea/fact + on/upon someone → strongly make someone understand/remember it****

This is excellent MCQ material because the same verb produces a clearly different interpretation through its grammatical pattern.

Family-extension note

The practical modern family includes:

* ****impress****

* ****impressed****

* ****impressing****

* ****impressive****

* ****impressively****

* ****impression****

The most important learner contrast is:

* ****impressed**** = 感到佩服的

* ****impressive**** = 令人佩服的

And the most important polysemy contrast is:

* ****impress someone**** = 令某人佩服

* ****impress something on someone**** = 令某人深刻明白 / 記住

* ****impress a mark into/on something**** = 壓印圖案 / 留下印痕

The Golden Manual specifically says that grammatical patterns and related adjective contrasts should be separated when they produce genuinely different learner interpretations.

Master comparison

Form / sense	MCQ-ready Traditional Chinese meaning
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impress + person	透過能力、表現、特質或成就，使某人產生欣賞、佩服或高度評價
impress something on/upon someone	強烈地向某人指出某件事，使對方深刻理解、記住或重視
impress a mark/design on/into something	透過壓力在某個表面留下清楚的形狀、圖案或印痕
impressed	因別人的能力、表現或事物品質而感到欣賞、佩服或印象深刻的
impressive	因品質、能力、規模或表現出色而令人欣賞或佩服的
impressively	以令人欣賞、佩服或感到出色的方式
impression — opinion/feeling	接觸某人或某事物後，在腦中形成的整體看法或感受；其他 polysemy 宜另行處理

For your original sentence

> “He never talks just to ****impress**** people.”

The exact meaning is:

****impress** = 令別人因自己的能力、知識、表現或特質而感到佩服或留下深刻好印象**

So:

> ****talk just to impress people****

= **純粹為了讓別人佩服自己 / 對自己留下好印象而說話**

For your database, I would count **3 genuinely distinct core meanings** for **impress**:

1. **cause someone to admire or think highly of you/something**
2. **impress something on/upon someone — make an idea or fact strongly understood or remembered**
3. **physically press/stamp a mark, pattern, or design into/on a surface**

I would keep **impressed, impressive, impressively,** and **impression** as family extensions rather than increase the core **impress** count.